

» WADERS, GULLS, AND AUKS

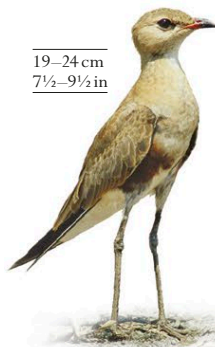


19–21 cm
7½–8½ in

CREAM-COLOURED COURSER

Cursorius cursor
F: Glareolidae

Often nocturnal, coursers are inconspicuous, long-legged ground birds, similar to plovers. This is a migratory species from Asia and Africa.



19–24 cm
7½–9½ in

AUSTRALIAN PRATINCOLE

Siltia isabella
F: Glareolidae

This pratincole from Australia and Indonesia usually stays close to fresh water, but has special glands that enable it to drink salt water too.

24–28 cm
9½–11 in

BLACK-WINGED PRATINCOLE

Glareola nordmanni
F: Glareolidae

Like other pratincoles, this species is migratory. It breeds in E. Europe and C. Asia and overwinters in Africa.



forked tail

27–28 cm
10½–11 in

HEUGLIN'S COURSER

Rhinoptilus cinctus
F: Glareolidae

Most coursers are restricted to arid deserts and scrub, but this African species also ventures into woodland habitats.



LITTLE PRATINCOLE

Glareola lactea
F: Glareolidae

This small species is from S. Asia. Like its relatives, the little pratincole feeds on insects in flight. It has a forked tail.



17–19 cm
6½–7½ in

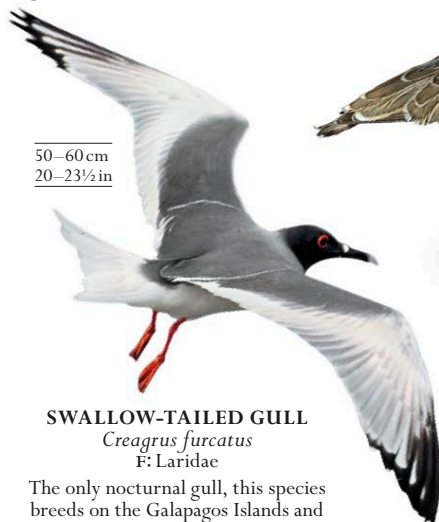
COLLARED PRATINCOLE

Glareola pratincola
F: Glareolidae

Like most pratincoles, this species from S. Europe and Africa gathers in large, noisy flocks on open wetlands.



23–26 cm
9–10 in



50–60 cm
20–23½ in

SWALLOW-TAILED GULL

Creagrus furcatus
F: Laridae

The only nocturnal gull, this species breeds on the Galapagos Islands and overwinters in S. America. It feeds on fish and squid.

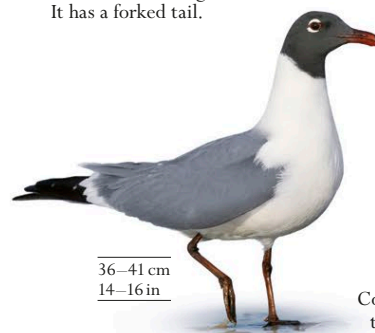


42–44 cm
16½–17½ in

DOLPHIN GULL

Leucophaeus scoresbii
F: Laridae

This gull is famously aggressive to other birds. It is confined to the southern tip of S. America and the Falkland Islands.

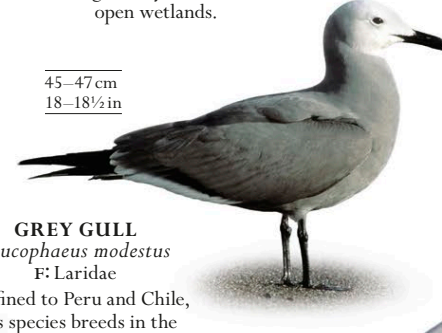


36–41 cm
14–16 in

LAUGHING GULL

Leucophaeus atricilla
F: Laridae

An American hooded gull, this species has a laughing call. It is a colonial breeder on coastal estuaries and salt marshes.

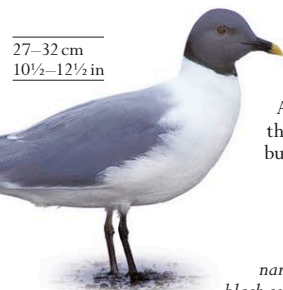


45–47 cm
18–18½ in

GREY GULL

Leucophaeus modestus
F: Laridae

Confined to Peru and Chile, this species breeds in the Atacama Desert, one of the driest regions of the world.

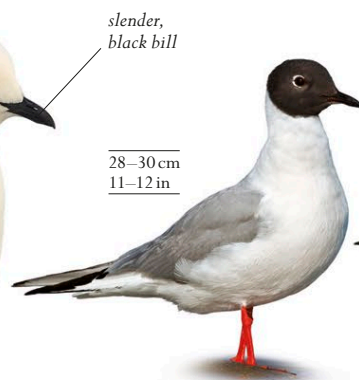


27–32 cm
10½–12½ in

SABINE'S GULL

Xema sabini
F: Laridae

A relative of the ivory gull, this bird is an Arctic breeder, but it migrates huge distances to overwinter in S. America and Africa.

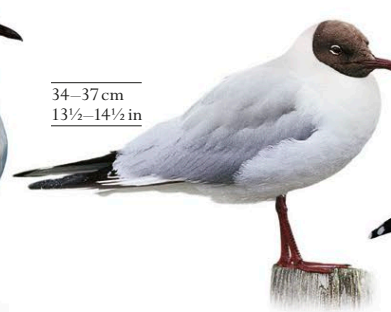


28–30 cm
11–12 in

BONAPARTE'S GULL

Chroicocephalus philadelphia
F: Laridae

A N. American masked gull, this species breeds in wet coniferous forests in Canada and winters along Caribbean coasts.



34–37 cm
13½–14½ in

COMMON BLACK-HEADED GULL

Chroicocephalus ridibundus
F: Laridae

Like other members of the masked gull group, this dark-headed gull becomes white headed in winter. It is abundant in the northern hemisphere.

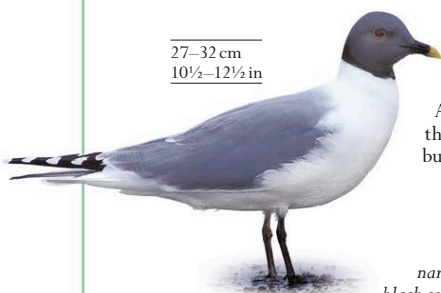


40–45 cm
16–18 in

SILVER GULL

Chroicocephalus novaehollandiae
F: Laridae

Despite its different appearance, this Australian gull is related to the common black-headed gull. It visits human refuse sites to feed.

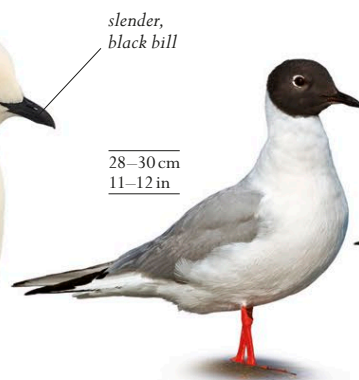


27–32 cm
10½–12½ in

SABINE'S GULL

Xema sabini
F: Laridae

A relative of the ivory gull, this bird is an Arctic breeder, but it migrates huge distances to overwinter in S. America and Africa.

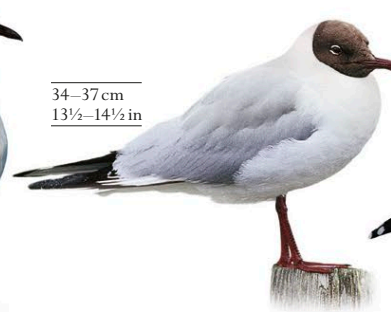


28–30 cm
11–12 in

BONAPARTE'S GULL

Chroicocephalus philadelphia
F: Laridae

A N. American masked gull, this species breeds in wet coniferous forests in Canada and winters along Caribbean coasts.



34–37 cm
13½–14½ in

COMMON BLACK-HEADED GULL

Chroicocephalus ridibundus
F: Laridae

Like other members of the masked gull group, this dark-headed gull becomes white headed in winter. It is abundant in the northern hemisphere.

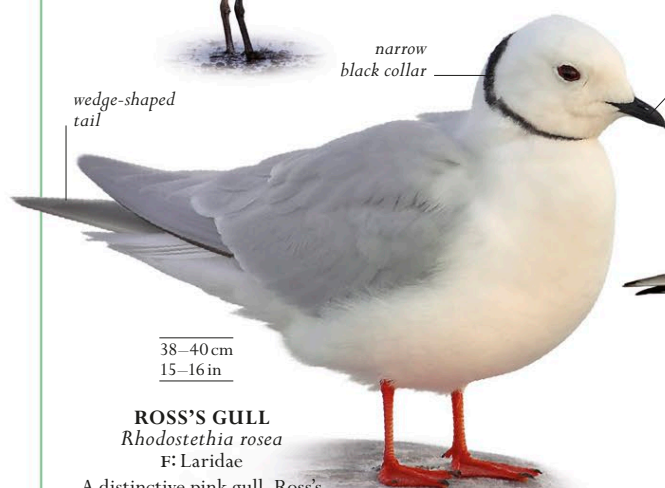


40–45 cm
16–18 in

SILVER GULL

Chroicocephalus novaehollandiae
F: Laridae

Despite its different appearance, this Australian gull is related to the common black-headed gull. It visits human refuse sites to feed.



38–40 cm
15–16 in

ROSS'S GULL

Rhodostethia rosea
F: Laridae

A distinctive pink gull, Ross's gull breeds in swampy and wooded Arctic tundra, and winters along coasts and at sea.

narrow black collar

slender, black bill

wedge-shaped tail